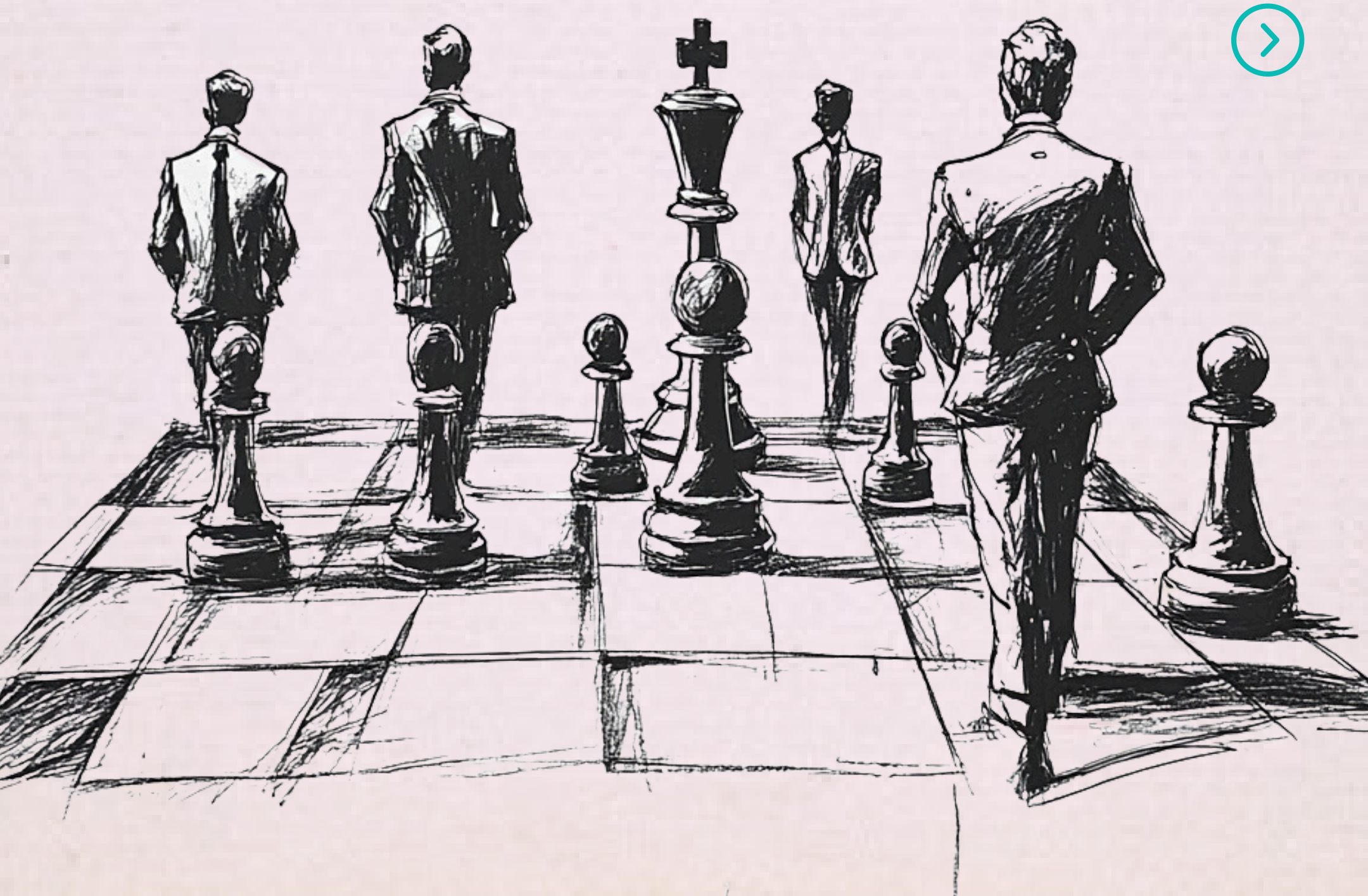
HOW TO
MANAGE YOUR BOSS

Learn to influence
7 types of leaders



1 The Relentless Micromanager

Characteristics:

- Needs to control every detail.
- Asks for constant updates.

How to Manage Up:

- Provide frequent, detailed updates before they ask.
- Avoid surprises

Trust Language:

-High-velocity details

2 The Volatile Visionary

Characteristics:

- Focuses on big ideas + long-term goals.
- Always extreme: sees failure or excellence.

How to Manage Up:

- Align your work with their vision
- Break big goals into actionable steps
- Show how your tasks contribute to the big picture.

Trust Language:

- How to unlock exponential results

3 The Hands-Off Auto-Pilot

Characteristics:

- Absent. Trusts the team to manage themselves.
- Rarely provides direct guidance.

How to Manage Up:

- Take initiative- lead projects without waiting for direction.
- Provide periodic updates
- Seek their input when necessary but be prepared to make decisions independently.

Trust Language:

- Forgiveness debriefs

4 The Data-Driven Scientist

Characteristics:

- Relies on data for decision-making.
- Prefers detailed reports and factual information.

How to Manage Up:

- Present your ideas and updates with clear, data-backed evidence
- Be precise + avoid anecdotal information.
- Use charts, graphs, and statistics to support your points.

Trust Language:

- Nothing but the facts.

5 The Overwhelmed Plate-Spinner

Characteristics:

- Juggles many responsibilities and is constantly busy.
- Appears stressed and overworked.

How to Manage Up:

- Offer solutions, not just problems, to lighten their load.
- Be concise in your communications.
- Prioritize tasks that align with their most immediate concerns.

Trust Language:

- "Let me help with that."

6 The Disconnected Diva

Characteristics:

- Seems out of touch with the organization and its strategy.
- Not fluent in the day-to-day challenges the team faces.

How to Manage Up:

- Help them connect the dots by providing context on key issues.
- Explain how the team's work aligns with the broader strategy.

Trust Language:

- Repeatable Anecdotes.

7 The Political Player

Characteristics:

- Highly attuned to organizational dynamics and relationships
- Makes decisions based on political implications

How to Manage Up:

- Frame proposals in terms of stakeholder impact and buy-in
- Help identify potential allies and obstacles for initiatives

Trust Language:

- Stakeholder Maps

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